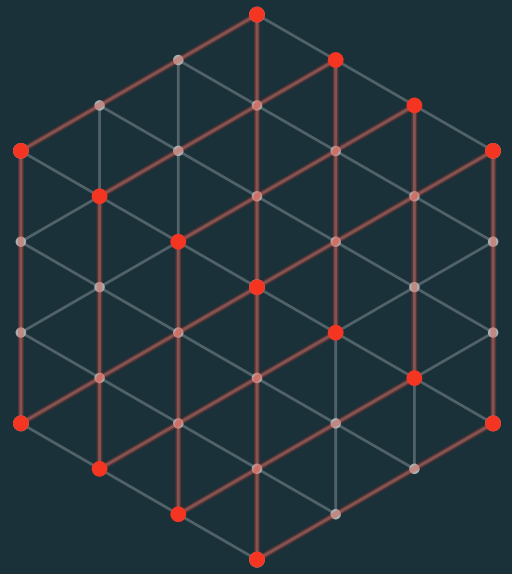
databricks

EASTWIND GOURMET · SPECIALTY FOOD RETAIL



# Forecast-driven replenishment

You can’t forecast a gift box for a highway kiosk the way you do downtown.

For the VP Merchandising and the CIO

October 2026

THE OUTCOME

# What you get

LOST SALES RECOVERED · TARGET

## $2–3M/yr

10–15% of today's $17.8M/yr lost sales

Conservative: the peak-season backtest cut modelled lost sales in every channel and every holiday window

PLAN-FOR COVERAGE

## 91–92%

of store-SKU-weeks land within the p90 plan-for quantity

Calibrated p90 band drives safety stock, so you know how much buffer you are buying

ONE PLATFORM

## 1

platform from ingestion to ML, apps, and Gen AI

6 capabilities on Databricks under one governance layer. No tool sprawl, no copies between vendors, one bill

**VP Merchandising:** fuller shelves on peak gifts, and orders your managers trust.

**CIO:** one governed platform from POS to order, traceable end to end.

THE PROBLEM

# Ordering by gut feel

## 80 stores, 3 channels, one gift box that sells three ways

| DOWNTOWN | HIGHWAY | AIRPORT |
|---|---|---|
| 32 | 26 | 22 |
| stores | kiosks | stores |

Managers order from experience. Holiday peaks make the swings larger.



## You lose both ways

**$17.8M**

lost sales a year from stockouts

**$3.87M**

expired and marked down a year

PEAKS AMPLIFY IT

18.7–21.1% of peak-gift store-days stocked out in Mid-Autumn 2025, vs 8.6% overall. Peak gifts carry 57.5% of lost sales.

FOR THE CIO

# Why it’s hard

01

## Five siloed sources

POS · ERP inventory · Product catalog · Store master · Holiday calendar

Different owners, formats, and refresh cycles. Even store IDs differ: `DT001` vs `L0001`.

02

## Stockouts hide demand

When the shelf is empty, sales stop, so history understates what customers wanted.

One mooncake line was out of stock 6 and 7 days in its two peak weeks.

03

## Festivals move

Lunar holidays land in a different week each year, so “same week last year” points at the wrong week.

Mid-Autumn fell on Sep 17 in 2024 and Oct 6 in 2025.

04

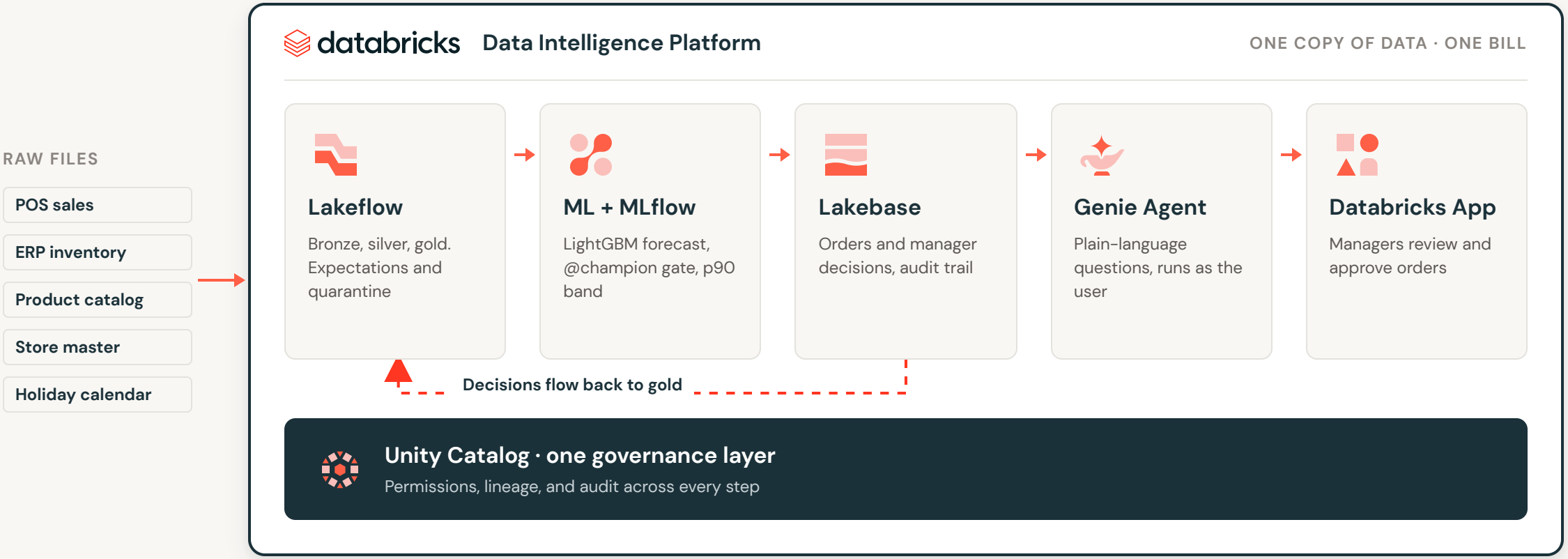
## Stitched-together stack

ETL tool · Warehouse · ML platform · OLTP database · BI / chat · App hosting

Every hop adds a data copy, a handoff, and another set of permissions to keep in sync.

ARCHITECTURE

# One platform, end to end




One weekly job refreshes data, scores the @champion model, builds orders, loads Lakebase, and ingests decisions.

HOW IT WORKS

# Pain point to result

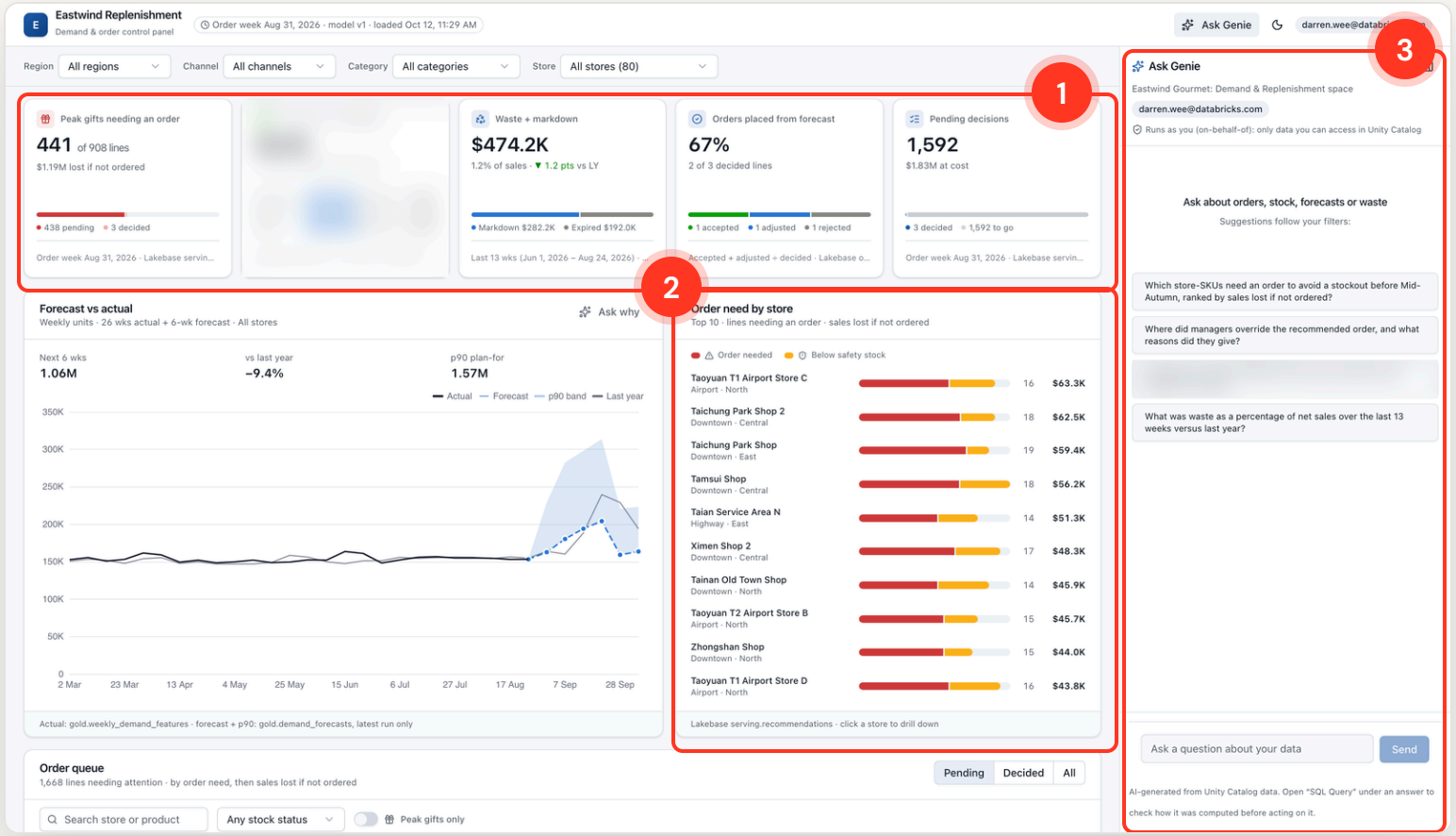
| PAIN POINT | DATABRICKS CAPABILITY | RESULT |
|---|---|---|
| **Fragmented data** | Lakeflow + Unity Catalog: one governed view | 0 mismatched weeks; 40 bad rows quarantined |
| **Hidden demand** | Stockout-aware training | Weeks distorted by empty shelves kept out of training |
| **Holiday swings** | Festival-aligned features | Forecast peaks in the lead-up weeks to the festival |
| **Distrust** | Reasons in units, plus a p90 band on every line | Peak-gift demand within p90 in 90–95% of weeks |
| **Slow decisions** | One-click approve in the App, on Lakebase | Accept, adjust, or reject with a reason, all audited |
| **Ad-hoc questions** | Genie Agent on governed gold tables | 11 of 11 benchmark questions correct, SQL shown |



**Every row runs on one platform: same data, same permissions, no copies.**

THE APP

# What managers see

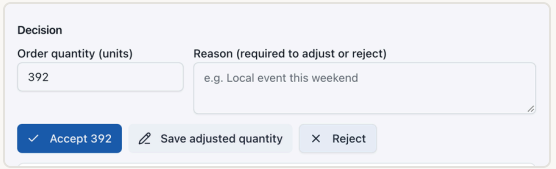



**1 KPI strip**

Peak gifts at risk, waste, and adoption at a glance.

**2 Order queue**

Ranked by sales at risk. Accept in one click, or adjust with a reason.




**3 Ask Genie**

Plain-language questions, answered with your access and the SQL shown.

IMPACT AND PROOF

# Proven vs next

| SUCCESS MEASURE | EVIDENCE | STATUS | NEXT |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Forecast accuracy by channel** | Beats today's method in every channel and both holiday seasons<br>See build evidence, section 5 | Proven | Track live by channel |
| **Stockouts on peak gift SKUs** | Modelled lost sales down in every window and channel<br>Baseline: 18.7–21.1% of peak-gift days out | Simulated | Measure in the pilot |
| **Expired and marked-down value** | Flat: +$42k/yr in the backtest<br>Baseline: $3.87M/yr | Not yet | Waste-aware policy, phase 2 |
| **Orders placed from forecast** | Test decisions only so far | Not yet | Track in the pilot |

PEAK-SEASON BACKTEST

**$26.8M/yr**

lost sales avoided vs manual ordering, pooled across 25 holiday weeks

Peak-window annualised, not a whole-year estimate. It shows the $2–3M/yr target is conservative.

*Policy backtest is a simulation on synthetic data; a full-year replay comes before any finance claim.*

ROADMAP

# 30 / 60 / 90 days

Day 30

## Governance pack

Row filters by region, column masks on cost, persona groups, lineage in UC.

Day 60

## Waste-aware ordering

Add shelf-life and waste limits to the order rule; replay a full year.

Day 90

## One-region pilot

Managers order from the app; you measure all four success measures live.

THE ASK

## Approve a one-region pilot

You get live proof on stockouts, waste, and adoption before a network-wide rollout.